

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | SIEM/SOAR | EDR/XDR | Vulnerability Management | Incident Response | Financial Services

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Cyber Security Engineer with over five years of hands-on experience implementing and hardening robust security controls across global enterprise infrastructure. I bring technical ownership capability across the full security stack, including Security Information and Event Management (SIEM), Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR), Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) / Extended Detection and Response (XDR), email and web security gateways, firewall management, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), Mobile Device Management (MDM), Privileged Access Management (PAM), and vulnerability management. I have a proven track record of working within small, focused security teams where I own security engineering end-to-end and report directly to senior security leadership. I am experienced in the financial services and SaaS sectors, comfortable operating in high-stakes environments where security and compliance are business-critical, and I bring both the technical depth and the communication skills to contribute immediately in a senior individual contributor capacity.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) / Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR):** Microsoft Sentinel (Kusto Query Language (KQL)); CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM; SOAR playbook design and automation
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) / Extended Detection and Response (XDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon (EDR, Prevent, NG-SIEM, Insight, Discover - Expert); Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE); Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI)
- **Email and Web Security Gateways:** Mimecast; email anti-phishing, impersonation protection, and threat intelligence integration
- **Identity and Access Management (IAM) / Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) / Single Sign-On (SSO):** Microsoft Entra Identity (formerly Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access Policies, MFA, SSO, Group Policy
- **Privileged Access Management (PAM):** BeyondTrust PAM; just-in-time access, session recording, least-privilege enforcement
- **Mobile Device Management (MDM) / Mobile Application Management (MAM):** Microsoft Intune; endpoint compliance policies
- **Vulnerability Management:** Pentra Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus; penetration test remediation; risk prioritisation and tracking
- **Firewall and Network Security:** Check Point Harmony Firewall; Web Application Firewall (WAF) / Distributed Denial of Service (DDoS) protection; Intrusion Detection and Prevention System (IDS/IPS) management; network segmentation
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61, MITRE ATT&CK, Tier 2/3 Security Operations Centre (SOC) alert triage, investigation, containment, and recovery
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell; SOAR automation; security task scripting and workflow optimisation
- **Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials+, MITRE ATT&CK

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL) - Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 - Present*

- Take full technical ownership of the organisation's security stack, implementing, maintaining, and hardening robust security across a global, multi-site infrastructure serving an 8,000-user estate.

- Manage Web Application Firewall (WAF) and Distributed Denial of Service (DDoS) protection configurations, ensuring availability and resilience of internet-facing services.
- Administer email and web security gateways (Mimecast), configuring anti-phishing, malicious URL scanning, and impersonation protection policies to defend against email-borne threats.
- Manage Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) and Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) platforms - Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM - authoring detection rules, analytics, and automated playbooks to accelerate alert triage and incident response.
- Administer CrowdStrike Falcon Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) and Extended Detection and Response (XDR) platforms, tuning detection policies and responding to EDR alerts for the full user estate.
- Configure and manage Check Point Harmony enterprise firewall including rule management, policy review, and security hardening.
- Enforce Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) and Single Sign-On (SSO) across the organisation using Microsoft Entra Identity (formerly Azure Active Directory) and Conditional Access Policies.
- Administer Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM) policies and device compliance baselines.
- Lead vulnerability management using Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Tenable.io, AppCheck, and Nessus; remediate penetration test findings and track risk reduction to closure.
- Manage digital certificate lifecycle, Intrusion Detection and Prevention System (IDS/IPS) monitoring, and security awareness training delivery across the organisation.
- Administer BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM), enforcing least-privilege access and session recording for privileged accounts.
- Deliver Tier 2/3 Security Operations Centre (SOC) incident response, leading investigations from detection through containment, eradication, and recovery in line with NIST 800-61 and MITRE ATT&CK.
- Develop PowerShell scripts and SOAR automation to reduce manual security operations workload and improve mean time to respond (MTTR).

University of the Arts, London (UAL) - Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

- Performed Security Operations Centre (SOC) alert triage, investigation, and escalation across SIEM and EDR platforms, maintaining low mean time to detect (MTTD) and mean time to respond (MTTR).
- Managed identity and access governance including user provisioning, access reviews, and role-based access control (RBAC) across Active Directory and Microsoft Entra Identity.
- Contributed to SOAR automation design, developing playbooks to automate common response actions including account lockdown, IP blocking, and evidence collection.
- Conducted vulnerability assessments and tracked remediation activity, reporting risk exposure to senior stakeholders and coordinating fixes with IT operations.
- Assisted with penetration test exercises, coordinated remediation across network, endpoint, and application layers, and supported certificate and gateway management.
- Delivered security awareness training and phishing simulation campaigns to reduce the human risk vector.
- Supported Cyber Essentials+ certification activities, documenting technical controls for audit submission.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) - IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

- Delivered security engineering and infrastructure support across a SaaS and FinTech environment, implementing endpoint security controls, patch management, and access governance.
- Configured firewall rules, MFA enforcement, SSO integrations, and network access controls to enforce a least-privilege security model.
- Managed MDM/MAM policies for corporate devices and performed regular vulnerability scanning with remediation coordination across development and operations teams.
- Supported ISO 27001-aligned information security management activities including risk assessments, policy development, and third-party supplier assessments.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Took full technical ownership of a complex, multi-site security stack serving 8,000 users, hardening controls across endpoint, identity, gateway, firewall, and vulnerability management layers.

- Led end-to-end CrowdStrike Falcon deployment, establishing expert-level EDR/XDR visibility across the enterprise and significantly improving threat detection speed and accuracy.
- Engineered Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) deployment across the full 8,000-user estate, consolidating endpoint and identity threat protection.
- Built SIEM/SOAR automation capability in Microsoft Sentinel that automated common alert triage and containment workflows, reducing analyst workload and improving mean time to respond (MTTR).
- Implemented BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) to enforce just-in-time access controls, substantially reducing the attack surface associated with privileged credentials.
- Achieved Cyber Essentials Plus certification, demonstrating robust security controls across gateway, endpoint, identity, and network layers in line with UK government security standards.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London/UK)